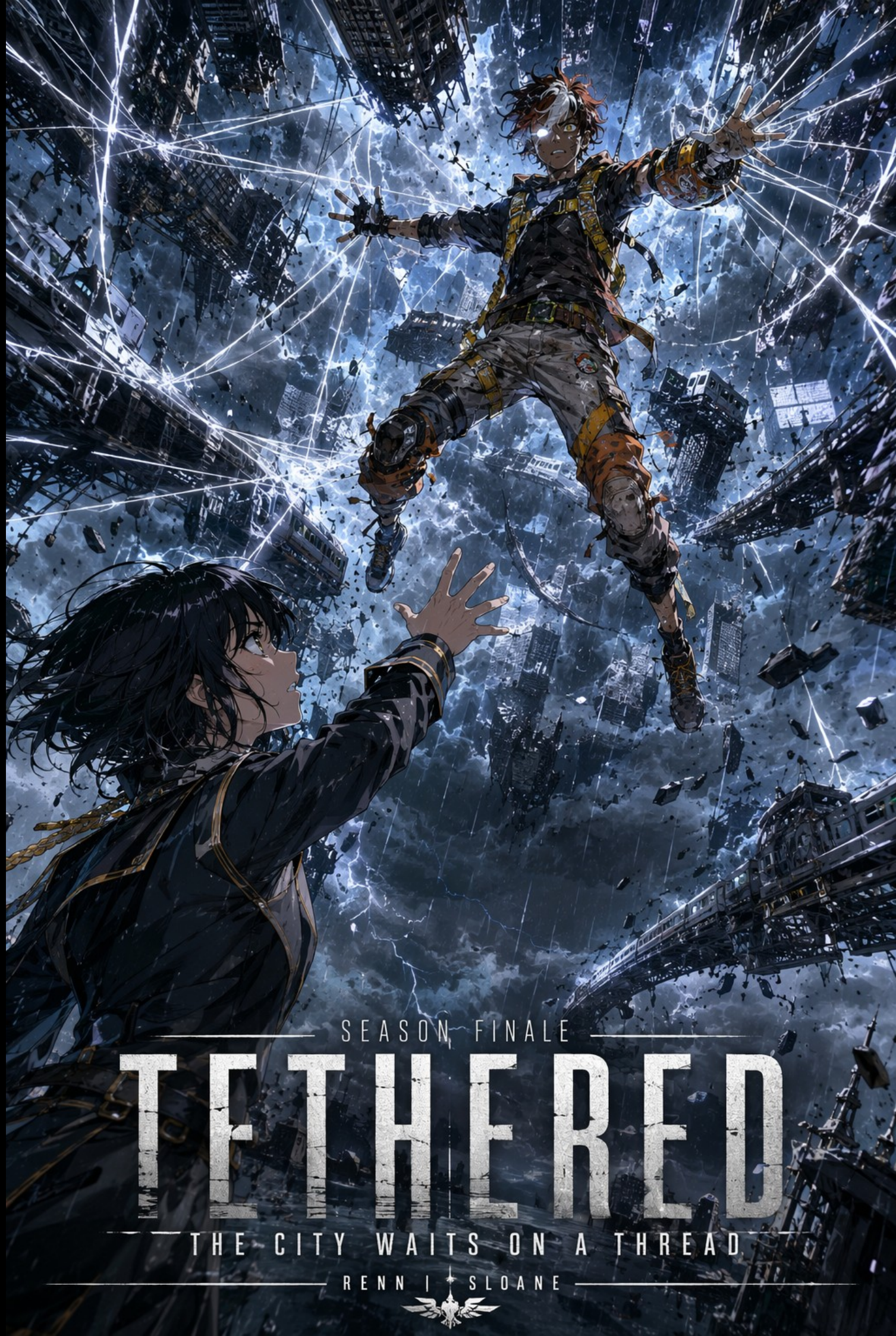




SEASON FINALE

TETHERED

THE CITY WAITS ON A THREAD

RENN | SLOANE



MASTER KNOT CHAMBER.
DEPTH: UNKNOWN.

The Spindle Storm is a living thing.

It climbs.

It hungers.

And it comes for everything we've built.

WE DON'T HAVE TIME TO CLIMB—

TAK TAK

TAK TAK

I-I CAN'T HEAR THE TICKS—!

The floor is gone.

Sloane won't.

Not like that.

Renn?

Renn's the only one still stupid enough to try something that might work.

IF WE CAN LOCK THE LINE TO THE SPINE—

The Spindle Storm is almost here.

And it's not coming to ask permission.



THE MASTER KNOT,
SEVERED.

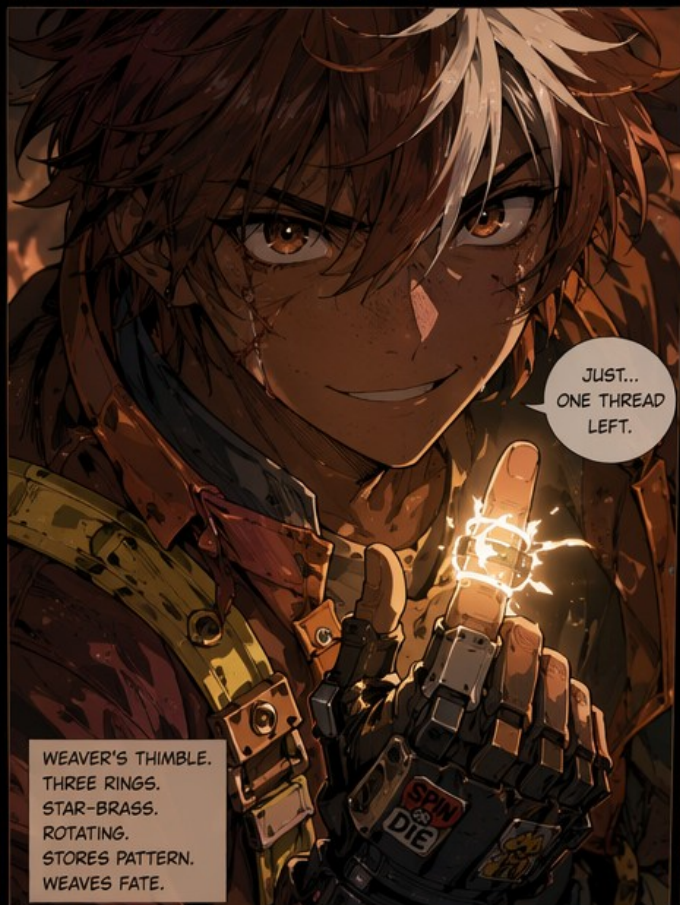
DIMMING.

AND RENN—
STILL SMILING.



RENN...
WHAT ARE
YOU—

SLOANE,
VANGUARD CADET.
RANK REMOVED.
STILL HOLDS
THE LINE.



JUST...
ONE THREAD
LEFT.

WEAVER'S THIMBLE.
THREE RINGS.
STAR-BRASS.
ROTATING.
STORES PATTERN.
WEAVES FATE.



R-RENN...
DON'T...

BIX.
FOURTEEN.
TICKS COUNT
WHAT WE
CANNOT.



THREADS SHED.
DIM.
FADE.



BRASS
FRAGMENTS.
FIBER DUST.
HEAT SHIMMER.



I'M NOT
BREAKING IT.

I'M
FINISHING
IT.



RENN—
LISTEN TO ME!

YOU CAN'T GO
OUT THERE!

TICK-
TICK-
TICK-
TICK-

THE TENSION
ISN'T STABLE!
IT'S **SPIKING!**



KRRR-

TICK!
TICK!
TICK!

IF YOU
OVERTENSION
THAT LINE—

THE WHOLE
SOUTH RIG
WILL—

BIX,
MOVE.

I GOT
THIS.



NO!

PLEASE—
JUST
LISTEN!

YANK



K-K-K-
KRRRRRRR-
!!!



...BIX.



IF IT SPIKES
AGAIN...

...WE ALL
DIE.



RENN.

PLEASE.

DON'T
DO THIS.



I KNOW
WHAT YOU'RE
PLANNING.

AND I KNOW
YOU THINK IT'S
THE ONLY WAY.

BUT IT'S
NOT.

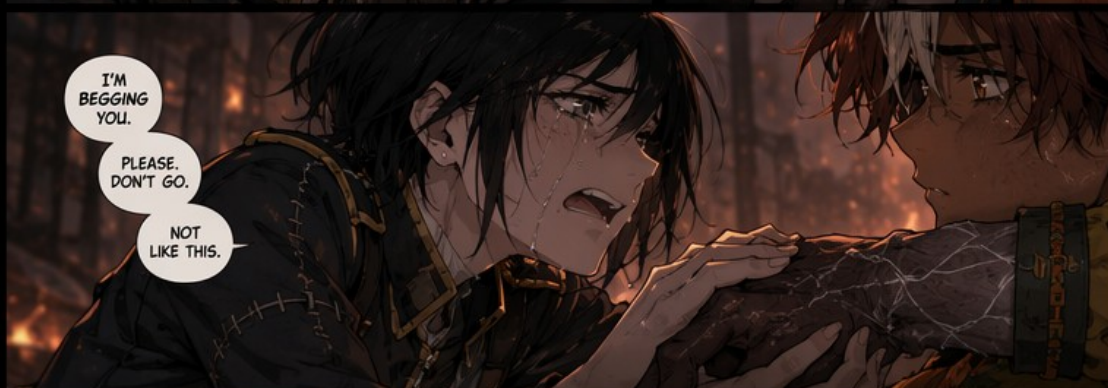
PLEASE.
LET ME
COME WITH
YOU.



DON'T MAKE
ME WATCH YOU
DISAPPEAR LIKE
EVERYONE ELSE.



SLOANE...



I'M
BEGGING
YOU.

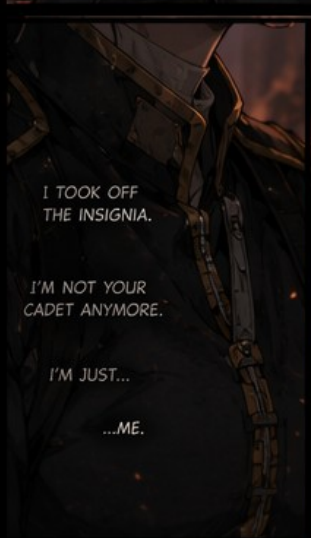
PLEASE.
DON'T GO.

NOT
LIKE THIS.

YOU
DON'T
HAVE TO
DO THIS
ALONE.



I WON'T
LET YOU.

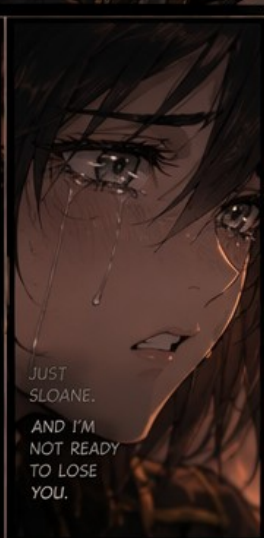


I TOOK OFF
THE INSIGNIA.

I'M NOT YOUR
CADET ANYMORE.

I'M JUST...

...ME.



JUST
SLOANE.
AND I'M
NOT READY
TO LOSE
YOU.



PLEASE.
DON'T
CHOOSE THIS.

NOT
OVER
US.



THE SPOOL IS
DENTED.

THE LINE
WON'T
HOLD.

YOU
MIGHT NOT
COME BACK.



I'D RATHER
HATE YOU
FOREVER—

—THAN NEVER
SEE YOU
AGAIN.

THE SKY SPLIT
LIKE A BAD WOUND.

THE CITY
COULDN'T HOLD.

BIX COULDN'T
EITHER.

NOT TODAY.

RENN...

HEY.
YOU'RE STILL
WITH ME.

THAT'S ENOUGH
VICTORY FOR
ONE DAY.

BREATHE.
YOU DON'T
HAVE TO BE
ANYTHING
RIGHT NOW.

NOT EVEN
STRONG.

JUST...
STAY.

SOME THINGS
BREAK SO QUIET,
NOT EVEN TIME
CAN FIX THEM.

BUT IN ALL THIS
FALLING APART--

I STILL
CHOOSE YOU.

TICK.
TICK.
TICK.

I'M
SCARED.

DON'T LET
GO.

NEVER.



IT'S
TOO MUCH...

I CAN'T—



WEAVER'S
THIMBLE.

DON'T THINK.
JUST—



I DON'T KNOW
WHAT IT DOES.

I JUST NEED
IT TO WORK.



PLEASE.



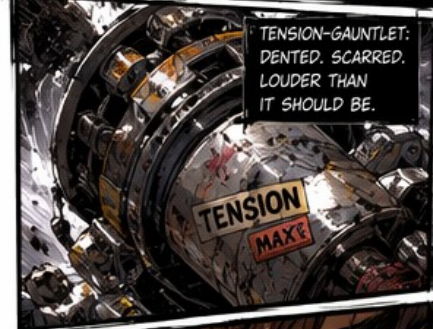
PLEASE.

WORK.



SIXTEEN.

FIRST TIME
PULLING GRAVITY.



TENSION-GAUNTLET:
DENTED. SCARRED.
LOUDER THAN
IT SHOULD BE.



DON'T THINK.
DON'T SECOND
GUESS.



PUNCH EMPTY.
HAUL SOMETHING
OUT.



PRAY YOUR
ANCHOR HOLDS.



GRAVITY ISN'T
SUPPOSED TO
COME LIKE THIS.
NOT LIKE A--



IT RECOILS.
HARDER THAN
IT LOOKS.



THERE'S NO
WINCH FOR
THIS.



JUST GRIP.
JUST LEGS.
JUST--



--HOPE.



THE WEFT
DOESN'T CARE
HOW YOU FEEL.

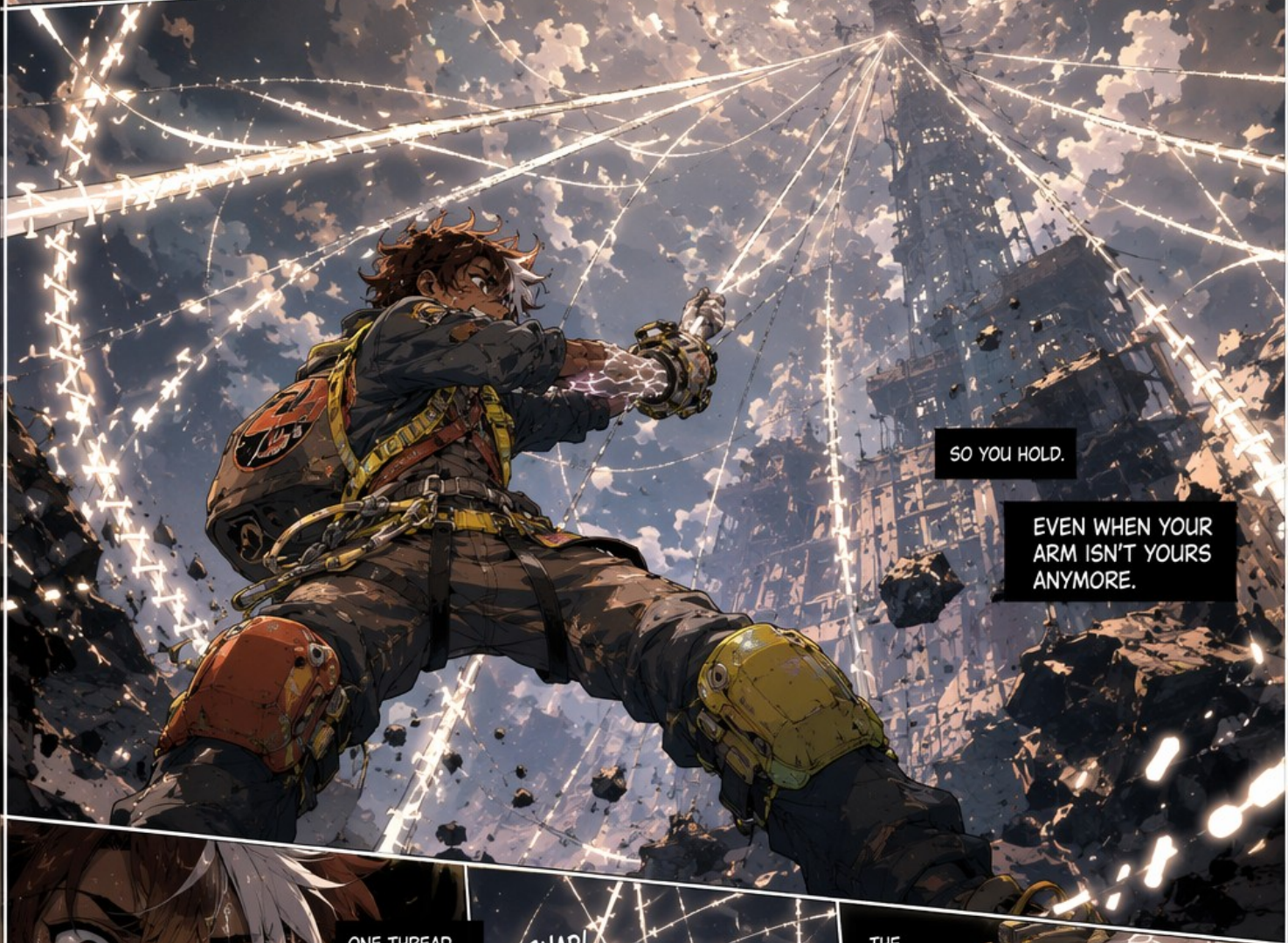
IT ONLY CARES
IF YOU HOLD.



LOCK.

FEED.

ANCHOR.



SO YOU HOLD.

EVEN WHEN YOUR
ARM ISN'T YOURS
ANYMORE.



ONE THREAD.
THEN ANOTHER.

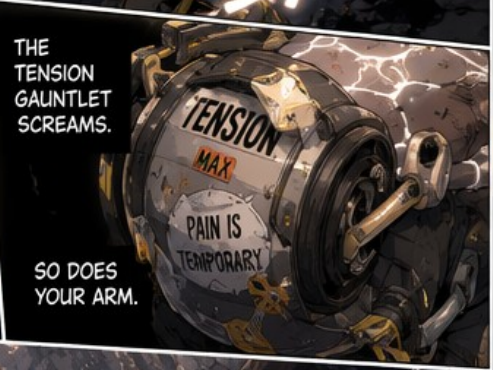
SNAP.
SNAP.
SNAP.

SNAP!

SNAP!

SNAP!

SNAP!



THE
TENSION
GAUNTLET
SCREAMS.

SO DOES
YOUR ARM.

BUT THE WEFT—
THE WEFT HOLDS
FOREVER.

KEEP WEAVING,
RENN.

RENN.

AGE: SIXTEEN
HEIGHT: 5'6"
WEIGHT: 112 LBS
CLIMBER. SCOUT.
SMARTASS.
NOT TODAY.

NNNGH—!

THE MARK
WASN'T SUPPOSED
TO SPREAD.

THE SPOOL
WASN'T SUPPOSED
TO BITE BACK.

THE WALL
WASN'T SUPPOSED
TO CHANGE ME.

NONE OF THIS
WAS SUPPOSED
TO HAPPEN.

IT HURTS.

LIKE EVERY NERVE
IS ON FIRE.

LIKE MY SKIN
IS TOO SMALL
FOR WHAT'S
GROWING
INSIDE IT.

LIKE SOMETHING
ELSE IS WEARING
MY FACE.

GRND
GRND

—AAAH!

STOP—!

PLEASE—!

I CAN'T
CONTROL IT.

I CAN'T
STOP IT.

MAKE IT
STOP—!!

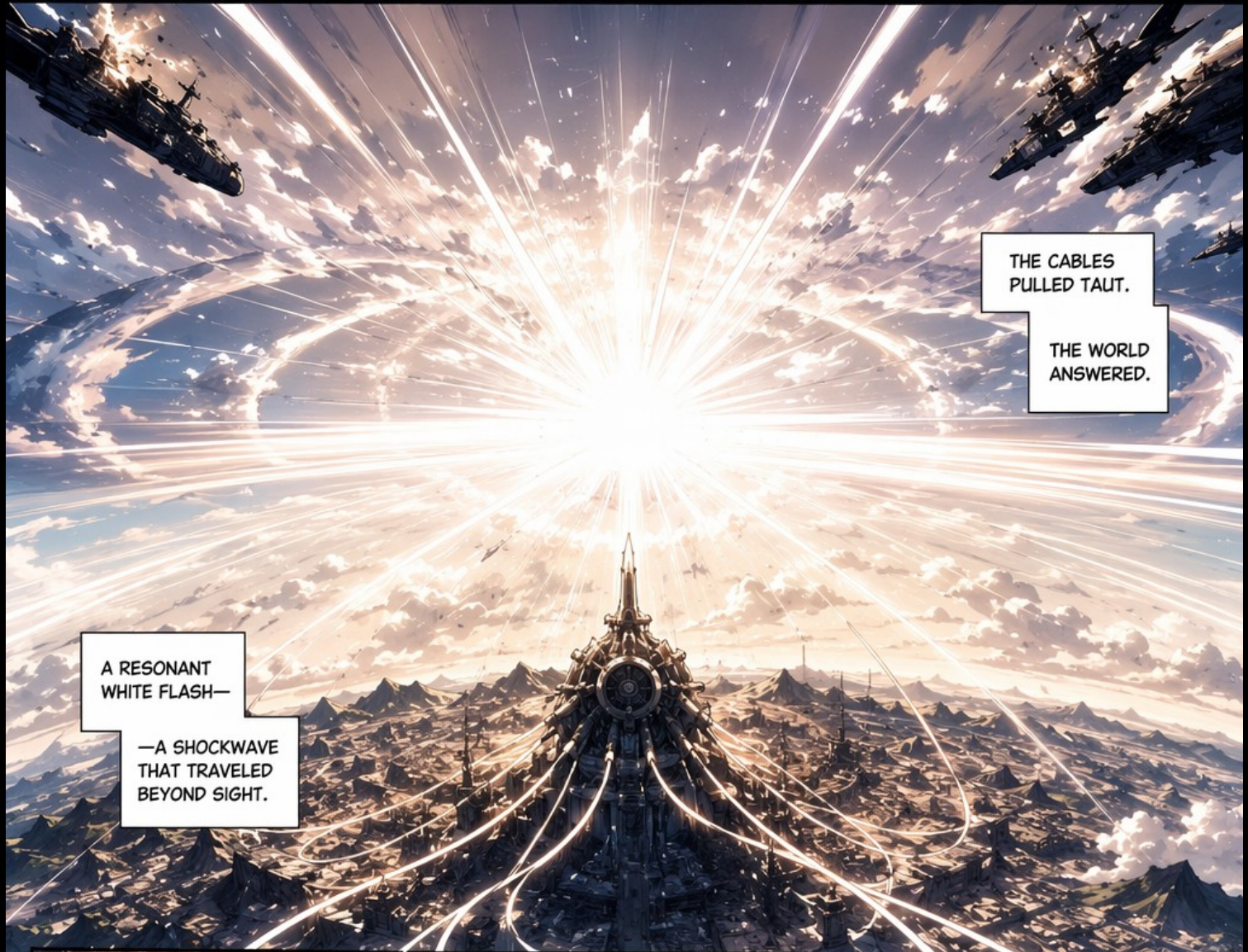
I CAN'T ONLY
FEEL IT.

AND IT FEELS
LIKE DYING.



IN THAT
INSTANT—

—THE VANGUARD
FLEET, STATIONED
ABOVE THE CLOUDS,
SHATTERED.



THE CABLES
PULLED TAUT.

THE WORLD
ANSWERED.

A RESONANT
WHITE FLASH—

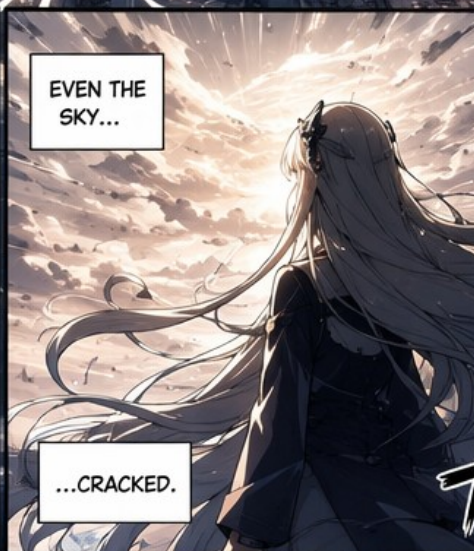
—A SHOCKWAVE
THAT TRAVELED
BEYOND SIGHT.



LIGHT.
PRESSURE.
SILENCE.

EVEN THE
SKY...

...CRACKED.



AND FROM THAT
FLASH—

A NEW ERA
BEGAN.





THEY
CALLED
IT
IMPOSSIBLE.

A CITY
THAT
DEFIES
GRAVITY.

SUSPENDED
ABOVE THE
ENDLESS
SPINDLE.

LOOK
AT IT...

THE WHOLE
CITY... HELD
IN PLACE.

BY WHAT?

THOSE
THREADS
SHOULDN'T
EXIST.

NOT
THREADS.

WILL.

WOVEN
BY EVERY
HANDS.

EVERY
HEART.

WE
DIDN'T JUST
BUILD IT...

WE
LIFTED IT.

THEN
WE'LL
DEFEND IT.

TOGETHER.

AGAINST THE
STORM.
AGAINST FATE.

THIS CITY
WILL STAND.

AS LONG AS
WE DO.

RENN—!

K-CHK-

"TENSION-GAUNTLET"
LOCK ENGAGED.

RIGHT EYE
UNRESPONSIVE.

RENN!!

NO—
NO, NO,
NO—!

THE
SPOOL—!
IT'S
OVERRUNNING
HIS NERVES—!

PLEASE—
HOLD ON—

WHRRRRRR—

GREYSCAR
PROGRESSION:
87%
AND RISING.

RENN—
PLEASE—

LORD-WARDEN VALERIUS

ANCHORITE VANGUARD
DREADNOUGHT "VIGILANCE
OF THE PALATINE KEEP"

THE CITY IS
SECURED.

THE NET HOLDS.

WITHDRAW.

AT DAWN,
THE CANOPY PLATES
CATCH THE FIRST LIGHT.

AND WE LEAVE WHAT
MUST NOT BE FREE,
IN WHAT MUST NOT
BE BROKEN.

THEY WILL
CALL IT
MERCY.

IT IS NOT.

IT IS
BALANCE.

SIGNAL
RETRIEVAL.

ALL VESSELS,
DISENGAGE.

VECTOR
CANOPY PLATES.

AYE,
LORD-WARDEN.

WE DO NOT
CONQUER THIS DAY.
WE REMEMBER
OUR PURPOSE.
AND WE
WITHDRAW.

THE CITY REMAINS.
THE NET REMAINS.
SO TOO, OUR WATCH.

UNTIL THE PATTERN
DECLARES OTHERWISE.



VIGILANCE
ENDURES.





to be continued...

TENSION NEVER SLEEPS.

RENN - BIX
ONE RHYTHM. ONE WORLD.

